

Gym Safety Guidelines & Equipment Policy

Effective Date: January 1, 2025 | Version 2.0 | Approved by: Fitness Director

1. General Safety Rules

All members must complete a safety orientation before using gym equipment for the first time. Proper athletic footwear is required at all times on the gym floor — no sandals, open-toed shoes, or bare feet. Members must wipe down all equipment after use with the provided sanitizing spray and towels. Personal belongings must be stored in lockers, not left on the gym floor. No food is allowed on the gym floor; water bottles with sealed lids are permitted.

2. Equipment Usage Rules

Equipment	Max Duration	Spotter Required	Certification Needed
Free Weights (< 20 kg)	No limit	No	No
Free Weights (20+ kg)	No limit	Yes	No
Squat Rack / Bench Press	30 min during peak	Yes for heavy lifts	No
Treadmill / Elliptical	45 min during peak	No	No
Cable Machines	No limit	No	No
Olympic Lifting Platform	45 min	Yes	Yes — trainer approval
Swimming Pool	60 min per session	Lifeguard on duty	Swim test required

3. Trainer Responsibilities

All personal trainers must maintain current CPR/AED certification and their primary fitness certification. Trainers must conduct a brief safety check of equipment before each personal training session. Group class instructors must arrive at least 10 minutes before class start time to set up equipment and greet arriving members. Trainers are responsible for ensuring members use proper form — if a member is performing an exercise with dangerous form, the trainer must intervene regardless of whether it is their client. Maximum trainer-to-client ratio for group training is 1:8 for strength classes and 1:15 for cardio/yoga/pilates classes.

4. Injury Prevention & Response

Members experiencing any pain beyond normal exercise discomfort must stop immediately and notify staff. First aid kits are located at the front desk, each group class studio, and the pool area. AED devices are wall-mounted at three locations: main entrance, weight room, and pool deck. All incidents must be documented in the Incident Report system within 24 hours. Members returning from injuries lasting more than 2 weeks must obtain a physician clearance letter before resuming training.

5. Class Safety Protocols

All group fitness classes have maximum capacity limits that must not be exceeded under any circumstances. HIIT and strength classes require a brief warm-up period of at least 5 minutes. Yoga and pilates classes must include cool-down and stretching in the final 10 minutes. Members new to a class format must inform the instructor before class begins so modifications can be provided. Heart rate monitors are recommended for all cardio and HIIT classes — the gym provides loaner monitors at the front desk.

6. Emergency Procedures

In case of a medical emergency, call 911 immediately, then notify the front desk. Staff trained in CPR/AED should begin first response while waiting for EMS. The gym evacuation route is posted at all exits. Fire extinguishers are located in the kitchen area, laundry room, and each studio. Monthly safety drills are conducted on the first Monday of each month at 6:00 AM before opening.